

The Revolt of "Mother"

Mary E. Wilkins Freeman · 1890

First published: Harper's Bazar, Sep 1890

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/A_New_England_Nun_and_Other_Stories/The_Revolt_of_"Mother" (revision 14965993), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Revolt of "Mother" suggest about women's rights in marriage?
- What does The Revolt of "Mother" suggest about home and dignity?
- What does The Revolt of "Mother" suggest about quiet rebellion?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Revolt of "Mother"	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*women's rights in marriage* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Revolt of "Mother"

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Mary E. Wilkins Freeman's life or times connects to women's rights in marriage in “The Revolt of "Mother"”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (women's rights in marriage, home and dignity, quiet rebellion).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Mary E. Wilkins Freeman was born in Randolph, Massachusetts, on 31 October 1852 and grew up in Randolph and Brattleboro, Vermont. After her parents' deaths left her with little money, she supported herself by writing; her collections A Humble Romance (1887) and A New England Nun (1891) portray the lives, especially women's lives, of small New England villages. In 1926 she received the William Dean Howells Medal for fiction. She died on 13 March 1930.

Historical and cultural context

Set in rural New England in the late nineteenth century, when farm wives had no legal claim to family property and few public voices. The title echoes the Revolution of 1776.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in Harper's New Monthly Magazine in September 1890; collected in A New England Nun and Other Stories (1891).

Then: Very popular; Freeman later wrote that it was unrealistic.

Now: Taught for its feminist themes and local colour.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Sarah Penn learns that her husband Adoniram is building a new barn on the spot where, forty years before, he had promised to build her a new house.

Main themes

- women's rights.
- marriage and communication.
- quiet rebellion.

Why it matters

It shows quiet, persistent resistance and invites comparisons to modern equality debates.

Spoilers · teacher only

While Adoniram is away, Sarah moves the family into the barn; he returns, is astonished, and agrees to fit it up as a house.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Revolt of "Mother": How do you stand up for yourself without shouting?
Prompt: Before we open The Revolt of "Mother": How do you stand up for yourself without shouting?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
local colour; dialect; characterization; allusion.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Mary E. Wilkins Freeman was born in Randolph, Massachusetts, on 31 October 1852 and grew up in Randolph and Brattleboro, Vermont. After her parents' deaths left her with little money, she supported herself by writing; her collections A Humble Romance (1887) and A New England Nun (1891) portray the lives, especially women's lives, of small New England villages. In 1926 she received the William Dean Howells Medal for fiction. She died on 13 March 1930. The world of the book. Set in rural New England in the late nineteenth century, when farm wives had no legal claim to family property and few public voices. The title echoes the Revolution of 1776. Publication and reception. First published in Harper's New Monthly Magazine in September 1890; collected in A New England Nun and Other Stories (1891). Then: Very popular; Freeman later wrote that it was unrealistic. Now: Taught for its feminist themes and local colour.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't as all this comes to" slowly and put it in my own words: Adoniram says he had no idea she was so set on this. Next, craft. I notice dialect and plain words, which make him sound honest and humbled. The strongest word is "idee": the spelling captures his rural voice and his surprise. Then, effect. What does Adoniram's line reveal at the end? My answer: He finally sees his wife's needs after forty years; the line shows the "revolt" has changed him.

> *I hadn't no idee you was so set on't as all this comes to (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't as all this comes to" slowly and put it in my own words: Adoniram says he had no idea she was so set on this. Next, craft. I notice dialect and plain words, which make him sound honest and humbled. The strongest word is "idee": the spelling captures his rural voice and his surprise. Then, effect. What does Adoniram's line reveal at the end? My answer: He finally sees his wife's needs after forty years; the line shows the "revolt" has changed him.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Sarah Penn learns that her husband Adoniram is building a new barn on the spot where, forty years before, he had promised to build her a new house. Themes to track: women's rights.: marriage and communication.: quiet rebellion.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: women's rights in marriage. Prediction: Sarah Penn's question about what the men are digging will start a quiet fight over who decides for the family. Question: what will "mother" do when Adoniram will not listen?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Revolt of "Mother": one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: women's rights in marriage. Prediction: Sarah Penn's question about what the men are digging will start a quiet fight over who decides for the family. Question: what will "mother" do when Adoniram will not listen?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Revolt of "Mother" still matter? It shows quiet, persistent resistance and invites comparisons to modern equality debates.
Anchor question: Why might The Revolt of "Mother" still be taught today?
Facilitation: It shows quiet, persistent resistance and invites comparisons to modern equality debates.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Freeman lived in rural New England and wrote local-color stories for magazines in the 1880s and 1890s. What did she want readers to notice about rural women's lives? Answer: Accept answers such as: hard work and little say in family decisions; quiet strength; how small acts could be bold.
Exit ticket: Freeman lived in rural New England and wrote local-color stories for magazines in the 1880s and 1890s. What did she want readers to notice about rural women's lives?
Answer: Accept answers such as: hard work and little say in family decisions; quiet strength; how small acts could be bold.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Revolt of "Mother".

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Mary E. Wilkins Freeman" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Mary-E-Wilkins-Freeman); Mary E. Wilkins Freeman, A New England Nun and Other Stories (1891) (https://www.gutenberg.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Sources differ on the first venue: our story metadata says Harper's Bazar, while many anthologies cite Harper's New Monthly Magazine (September 1890). Verify before printing.
- Freeman later criticized the story as unrealistic; this is usually traced to her 1917 Saturday Evening Post essay "Who's Who—and Why." Verify before quoting.

Lesson 2: The Revolt of "Mother"

Focus: a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “The Revolt of "Mother"” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (): No significant sensitive content flagged; preview as usual.
Student preview: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

For forty years Sarah Penn has waited for the new house her husband Adoniram promised. Instead he builds another barn. While he is away buying a horse, she moves the family and furniture into the new barn and makes it a home. Adoniram returns, is stunned, and weeps, saying he will put up partitions and windows: he never knew she was so set on it.

Background: Published in Harper's Bazar in 1890. Freeman wrote about rural New England, where farm wives had little legal say over property.

Significance: A regionalist story about a woman's independence; often paired with A Jury of Her Peers and The Story of an Hour.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to quiet rebellion because.... Content note before we start: Nothing in this story needs a special warning.
Prompt: How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to quiet rebellion because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: she acts rather than argues.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: sedulous — careful and persistent; scuttled — ran with short quick steps; inspecting — looking at closely; examining; mumbled — talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice; cambric — a fine, thin cotton or linen cloth. “inspecting”: Origin of “inspect”: Latin inspectum.
Words: sedulous: careful and persistent · scuttled: ran with short quick steps · inspecting: looking at closely; examining · mumbled: talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice · cambric: a fine, thin cotton or linen cloth

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in Harper's Bazar in 1890. Freeman wrote about rural New England, where farm wives had little legal say over property. A regionalist story about a woman's independence; often paired with A Jury of Her Peers and The Story of an Hour. Characterization: Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent. Dialect: New England speech. Allusion: Sarah's move compared to historical "revolts." Watch for the barn: Adoniram's priorities; it becomes a home.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "What are they digging for, mother" slowly and put it in my own words: Sarah asks her husband what the workers are digging, and he will not answer her. Next, craft. I notice it is a simple question, and the refusal to answer it says more than a long speech. The strongest word is "digging": it is the start of the new barn, the thing that will spark her revolt. Then, effect. Why does Sarah ask what the men are digging for? My answer: Sarah asks what the men are digging for because her husband makes major decisions without telling her; her question shows how little voice she has, which drives her to act.

> *What are they digging for, mother* *(The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "What are they digging for, mother" slowly and put it in my own words: Sarah asks her husband what the workers are digging, and he will not answer her. Next, craft. I notice it is a simple question, and the refusal to answer it says more than a long speech. The strongest word is "digging": it is the start of the new barn, the thing that will spark her revolt. Then, effect. Why does Sarah ask what the men are digging for? My answer: Sarah asks what the men are digging for because her husband makes major decisions without telling her; her question shows how little voice she has, which drives her to act.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The end. Look at the craft: New England speech. Ask: How does this line connect to quiet rebellion? Expected: She acts rather than argues. (The end.)

> *Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph* *(The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The end. Look at the craft: New England speech.
Ask: How does this line connect to quiet rebellion?
Expected answer: She acts rather than argues. (The end.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the story for characterization, dialect (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Revolt of "Mother" develops the idea of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. When the text says “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165), it shows this directly. Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph."

Task: Annotate the story for characterization, dialect (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Revolt of "Mother" develops the idea of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. When the text says “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165), it shows this directly. Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting? Ask: is Sarah's revolt justified?

Anchor question: How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting?

Facilitation: Ask: is Sarah's revolt justified?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. (“Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph”, The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. (“Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph”, The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Key takeaway: she acts rather than argues.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent.
- **Dialect:** New England speech.
- **Allusion:** Sarah's move compared to historical "revolts."

Themes and how they develop

- **quiet rebellion:** she acts rather than argues.

Symbols and motifs

- **the barn:** Adoniram's priorities; it becomes a home.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23) The question.
- “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165) The end.
- “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166) Adoniram.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed.
Evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165)
Reasoning: Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
sedulous (adjective)	careful and persistent	*However deep a resentment she might be forced to hold against her husband, she would never fail in sedulous attention to his wants.*	

scuttled (verb)	ran with short quick steps	*Men assembled in the store and talked it over, women with shawls over their heads scuttled into each other's houses before their work was done.*	
inspecting (verb)	looking at closely; examining	*Penn did not speak of it, and Adoniram did not mention it to her, although sometimes, upon a return from inspecting it, he bore himself with injured dignity.*	"inspecting": Origin of "inspect": Latin inspectum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inspect#Etymology)
mumbled (verb)	talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice	*And the old man bent his head and mumbled.*	
cambric (noun)	a fine, thin cotton or linen cloth	*Nanny was to be married in the fall, and she was sewing on some white cambric and embroidery.*	
premises (noun)	a house or building together with its grounds	*The hired man had milked, but he still hung around the premises.*	
retreated (verb)	pull back or move away or backward	*He added some more perplexed apologetic remarks; then he retreated.*	
solemnity (noun)	a trait of dignified seriousness	*When he had cleared the door-step, he turned and looked back with a kind of nervous solemnity. "I shall be back by Saturday if nothin' happens," said he.*	"solemnity": Origin: Old French solemnite; earlier Latin sollemnitās. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/solemnity#Etymology)
assembled (verb)	create by putting components or members together	*Men assembled in the store and talked it over, women with shawls over their heads scuttled into each other's houses before their work was done.*	

Discussion questions

1. How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting?
2. Where does characterization appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with women's rights in marriage?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16,

17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What has Adoniram promised Sarah? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A new house
2. What is Adoniram building? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A new barn
3. When does Sarah act? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: While Adoniram is away buying a horse
4. What does Sarah do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Moves the family into the new barn
5. How does Adoniram react? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He weeps and agrees to finish it as a house
6. Retell the three most important events of “The Revolt of "Mother"” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: For forty years Sarah Penn has waited for the new house her husband Adoniram promised. Instead he builds another barn. While he is away buying a horse, she moves the family and furniture into the new barn and makes it a home. Adoniram returns, is stunned, and weeps, saying he will put up partitions and windows: he never knew she was so set on it.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Revolt of "Mother"”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Revolt of "Mother"” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “However deep a resentment she might be forced to hold against her husband, she would never fail in sedulous attention to his wants.” What does “sedulous” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: sedulous: careful and persistent.
10. Reread: “Men assembled in the store and talked it over, women with shawls over their heads scuttled into each other's houses before their work was done.” What does “scuttled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: scuttled: ran with short quick steps.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Revolt of "Mother"” suggest about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A regionalist story about a woman's independence; often paired with A Jury of Her Peers and The Story of an Hour.
2. Find one example of characterization in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the conflict in this story shape what we understand about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23): The question. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “Sarah Penn's face as she rolled her pies had that expression of meek vigor which might have characterized one of the New Testament saints.”, why might Freeman have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Revolt of "Mother"”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: For forty years Sarah Penn has waited for the new house her husband Adoniram promised. Instead he builds another barn. While he is away buying a horse, she moves the family and furniture into the new barn and makes it a home. Adoniram returns, is stunned, and weeps, saying he will put up partitions…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Revolt of "Mother"” set up that the rest of The Revolt of "Mother" will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165): The end. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166): Adoniram. On characterization: Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How can someone stand up for themselves without shouting?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with women's rights in marriage? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23): The question. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in Harper's Bazar in 1890. Freeman wrote about rural New England, where farm wives had little legal say over property. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words

failed. Useful evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165): The end. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A regionalist story about a woman's independence; often paired with A Jury of Her Peers and The Story of an Hour.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166): Adoniram. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23): The question. On characterization: Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “The Revolt of "Mother"” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165): The end. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “The Revolt of "Mother"”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166): Adoniram. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to home and dignity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Freeman need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23): The question. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165): The end. On characterization: Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “The Revolt of "Mother"” treats a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Revolt of "Mother" see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166): Adoniram. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve women's rights in marriage? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23): The question. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165): The end. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary E. Wilkins Freeman about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Useful evidence: “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166): Adoniram. Theme link: she acts rather than argues. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Adoniram react?

   A. He is furious

   B. He moves out

   C. He sells the barn

   D. He weeps and agrees to finish it as a house

   Key: D (He weeps and agrees to finish it as a house)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 43: “The boy got his cap from a nail behind the door, took an old _____ from the shelf, and started for school.” Word bank: arithmetic, blossoms, vigorously, looking

   Key: arithmetic

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 58? “He wanted a game of _____ before school, and feared his father would give him some chores to do.”

   A. heavily

   B. embroidery

   C. forehead

   D. marbles

   Key: D (marbles)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Nanny was to be married in the fall, and she was sewing on some white _____ and embroidery.” Word bank: scuttled, sedulous, cambric, inspecting

   Key: cambric

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 21? “The woman stood a moment _____ after him, then she went out of the barn across a corner of the yard to the house.”

   A. slapped

   B. arithmetic

   C. looking

   D. blossoms

   Key: C (looking)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The hired man had milked, but he still hung around the _____.” Word bank: inspecting, premises, scuttled, sedulous

   Key: premises

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23: “What are they _____ for, mother”

   Key: digging

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When does Sarah act?

   A. After he dies

   B. While Adoniram is away buying a horse

   C. On Sunday

D. At night

Key: B (While Adoniram is away buying a horse)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 4: “There was a sudden dropping and enlarging of the lower part of the old man's face, as if some heavy weight had settled therein; he shut his mouth tight, and went on _____ the great bay mare.” Word bank: daughter, harnessing, slapped, embroidery

   Key: harnessing

10. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “There was a sudden dropping and enlarging of the lower part of the old man's face, as if some heavy weight had settled therein; he shut his…”

    B. “The old man glanced doggedly at his wife as he tightened the last buckles on the harness.”

    C. “The spring air, full of the smell of growing grass and unseen blossoms, came in their faces.”

    D. “He ran his words together, and his speech was almost as inarticulate as a growl.”

    Key: A (“There was a sudden dropping and enlarging of the lower part of the old man's face, as if some heavy weight had settled therein; he shut his…”)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 60 reveal about the character or situation? “Adoniram went to work out in the yard unloading wood from the wagon.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 60) shows the situation turning on home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The words “unloading” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The question. The evidence is “What are they digging for, mother” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23). This develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 106 reveal about the character or situation? “He looked at his wife, and his manner was defiantly apologetic, ‘If them cows come to-day, Sammy can drive 'em into the new barn,’ said he; ‘an' when they bring the hay up, they can pitch it in there.’” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 106) shows the situation turning on home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The words “apologetic” and “defiantly” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Adoniram. The evidence is “I hadn't no idee you was so set on't” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166). This develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The words “hadn't” and “on't” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 76 shapes its tone: “We ain't had no new paper on it for ten year, an' then I put it on myself, an' it didn't cost but ninepence a roll.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “ninepence” and “myself” (paragraph 76) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral.

That weight points the reader to home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how quiet rebellion develops from the opening of "The Revolt of 'Mother'" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Near the start, "What are they digging for, mother" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23) — The question. Later, "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 166) — Adoniram. She acts rather than argues.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Adoniram promised Sarah?
    A. A new dress
    B. A horse
    C. A new house
    D. A trip to Boston

    Key: C (A new house)
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He added some more perplexed apologetic remarks; then he _____." Word bank: retreated, inspecting, sedulous, scuttled
    Key: retreated
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Sarah do?
    A. Leaves her husband
    B. Moves the family into the new barn
    C. Sells the farm
    D. Burns the barn

    Key: B (Moves the family into the new barn)
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 76: "I ain't never _____, an' I ain't goin' to complain now, but I'm goin' to talk plain." Word bank: looking, complained, daughter, slapped
    Key: complained
21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 79 shapes its tone: "There ain't a prettier girl in town nor a more ladylike one than Nanny, an' that's the place she has to sleep in." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "ladylike" and "prettier" (paragraph 79) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 12 shapes its tone: "The old man glanced doggedly at his wife as he tightened the last buckles on the harness." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "tightened" and "doggedly" (paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 31 to the story's treatment of home and dignity: "He turned, and showed a face like his father's under his smooth crest of hair." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 31) develops home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. Its words "father's" and "turned" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Sammy, I want you to tell me if he's goin' to buy

more cows." (paragraph 39), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating home and dignity as central.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Adoniram building?

    A. A church

    B. A store

    C. A school

    D. A new barn

    Key: D (A new barn)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 122 shapes its tone: "Well, I s'pose he changed his mind.' He took hold of the horses' bridles." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "bridles" and "horses'" (paragraph 122) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 83 to the story's treatment of home and dignity: "She had pleaded her little cause like a Webster; she had ranged from severity to pathos; but her opponent employed that obstinate silence which makes eloquence futile with mocking echoes." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 83) develops home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. Its words "eloquence" and "obstinate" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "She had a scanty pattern for the shirts; she had to plan and piece the sleeves." (paragraph 88), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating home and dignity as central.

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165: "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was _____ by her own triumph"

    Key: overcome

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 47 to the story's treatment of home and dignity: "Her delicate face flushed pink, her lips pouted softly, as if she were going to cry." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 47) develops home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. Its words "delicate" and "flushed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Lots of girls have to that ain't no stronger an' better able to than you be.'" (paragraph 52), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating home and dignity as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 95 to the story's treatment of home and dignity: "Presently Adoniram clattered out of the yard in his two-wheeled dump cart, standing as proudly upright as a Roman charioteer." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 95) develops home and dignity: she acts rather than argues. Its words "charioteer" and "clattered" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Adoniram had planned to move his stock in on Wednesday; on Tuesday he received a letter which changed his plans." (paragraph 99), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating home and dignity as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "When he had cleared the door-step, he turned and looked back with a kind of nervous _____. 'I shall be back by Saturday

if nothin' happens,' said he." Word bank: solemnity, scuttled, sedulous, inspecting

Key: solemnity

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The end. The evidence is "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165). This develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in "The Revolt of 'Mother'"? New England speech.

    A. Dialect

    B. Conflict

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: A (Dialect)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "What are they digging for, mother" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The question. The evidence is "What are they digging for, mother" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 23). This develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The words "digging" and "mother" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph.".

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line "And the old man bent his head and mumbled.", what does "mumbled" most nearly mean?

    A. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice

    B. ran with short quick steps

    C. careful and persistent

    D. looking at closely; examining

    Key: A (talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "The Revolt of 'Mother'"? Sarah is patient and firm; Adoniram is silent.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Characterization

    C. Symbolism

    D. Simile

    Key: B (Characterization)

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165).

    Sample answer: Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph.". The evidence is "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph" (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165) — The end. This develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Revolt of ‘Mother’”?

    A. A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

    B. Courage in defense of home

    C. Human limits in an indifferent nature

    D. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

    Key: A (A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 5, 2, 6, 19, 20, 7, 10, 12, 11, 13, 21, 22, 15, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	4, 2, 17, 3, 6, 8, 24, 13, 10, 12, 11, 22, 25, 14, 23, 26	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 24, 6, 20, 5, 27, 10, 11, 12, 13, 21, 15, 22, 25, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 2, 8, 6, 5, 12, 13, 11, 10, 21, 25, 15, 14, 28, 26, 29	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	30, 7, 17, 24, 11, 31, 10, 32, 14, 15, 25, 22, 26, 28, 33, 29	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	30, 34, 24, 4, 17, 11, 10, 14, 15, 25, 21, 22, 26, 28, 16, 33	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 8, 4, 17, 10, 35, 25, 22, 14, 36, 21, 29, 26, 23, 33, 28	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Junior	34, 1, 4, 6, 10, 25, 15, 36, 22, 35, 21, 23, 28, 33, 26, 29	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	18, 4, 17, 24, 10, 37, 13, 12, 22, 15, 14, 25, 29, 26, 28, 23	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	1, 4, 6, 17, 10, 11, 25, 22, 15, 21, 35, 29, 28, 23, 26, 33	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Revolt of "Mother"," how does Freeman show a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In The Revolt of "Mother", how does Freeman develop the idea of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Revolt of "Mother" develops the idea of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least

three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Revolt of "Mother" (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Revolt of "Mother" suggests about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman uses characterization in The Revolt of "Mother" to complicate the reader's understanding of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Revolt of "Mother" within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Revolt of "Mother" alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Revolt of "Mother" and its treatment of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Revolt of "Mother" as evidence for a larger claim about a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home in The Revolt of "Mother". Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Revolt of "Mother" as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Revolt of "Mother".

SAT-style questions

1. *Penn did not speak of it, and Adoniram did not mention it to her, although sometimes, upon a return from inspecting it, he bore himself with injured dignity.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “inspecting” most nearly mean?

   A. create by putting components or members together

   B. looking at closely; examining

   C. a trait of dignified seriousness

   D. pull back or move away or backward

2. *Sarah Penn's face as she rolled her pies had that expression of meek vigor which might have characterized one of the New Testament saints. She was making mince-pies. Her husband, Adoniram Penn, liked them better than any other kind. She baked twice a week. Adoniram often liked a piece of pie between meals. She hurried this morning. It had been later than usual when she began, and she wanted to have a pie baked for dinner. However deep a resentment she might be forced to hold against her husband, she would never fail in sedulous attention to his wants.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Revolt of "Mother"”?

   A. A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home

   B. A woman's brief taste of freedom

   C. A girl's first encounter with death across the class line

   D. Hope created by an act of sacrifice

SAT key: 1. B (looking at closely; examining); 2. A (A wife's quiet rebellion for a decent home)

Unit test

The Revolt of "Mother": end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 36? “Her _____ was as bald and innocent as a baby's, with the light hair strained back from it in a row of curl-papers.”

   A. heavily
   B. complained
   C. harnessing
   D. forehead

   Key: D (forehead)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 76: “An' this is all the room my _____ will have to be married in.” Word bank: blossoms, daughter, heavily, marbles
   Key: daughter

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 76? “There ain't _____ woman in the whole town whose husband ain't got half the means you have but what's got better.”

   A. marbles
   B. character
   C. daughter
   D. another

   Key: D (another)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 60: “She was going down to the store to buy some more _____ and thread.” Word bank: arithmetic, embroidery, forehead, complained
   Key: embroidery

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 45? “The mother plunged her hands _____ into the water, the girl wiped the plates slowly and dreamily.”

   A. heavily
   B. vigorously
   C. forehead

D. harnessing

Key: B (vigorously)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 69? “He sat down _____; his face was quite stolid, but he looked at her with restive eyes.”

   A. embroidery

   B. heavily

   C. vigorously

   D. blossoms

   Key: B (heavily)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 22: “She was _____ three men who were digging over in the field which bounded the yard near the road line.” Word bank: blossoms, another, looking, watching

   Key: watching

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 11? “The spring air, full of the smell of growing grass and unseen _____, came in their faces.”

   A. looking

   B. blossoms

   C. daughter

   D. embroidery

   Key: B (blossoms)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 56: “Nobility of _____ manifests itself at loop-holes when it is not provided with large doors.” Word bank: character, slapped, arithmetic, heavily

   Key: character

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 12: “He _____ the reins over the horse, and started forth from the barn.” Word bank: heavily, forehead, arithmetic, slapped

    Key: slapped

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 88 reveal about the character or situation? “She had a scanty pattern for the shirts; she had to plan and piece the sleeves.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 88) shows the situation turning on quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The words “sleeves” and “pattern” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 8 reveal about the character or situation? “He ran his words together, and his speech was almost as inarticulate as a growl.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 8) shows the situation turning on women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The words “inarticulate” and “together” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 39 reveal about the character or situation? “Sammy, I want you to tell me if he's goin' to buy more cows.” Answer in two or

three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 39) shows the situation turning on quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 77 reveal about the character or situation? “She flung open a door and disclosed a tiny bedroom, only large enough for a bed and bureau, with a path between.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 77) shows the situation turning on women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The words “disclosed” and “between” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 21 shapes its tone: “It was scarcely as commodious for people as the little boxes under the barn eaves were for doves.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “commodious” and “scarcely” (paragraph 21) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 82 shapes its tone: “She'll have to go somewheres else to live away from us, an' it don't seem as if I could have it so, noways, father.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “somewheres” and “father” (paragraph 82) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 91 shapes its tone: “I'd be ashamed to have his folks come if we didn't have anybody else.’” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “ashamed” and “anybody” (paragraph 91) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 73 to the story's treatment of women's rights in marriage: “I tell ye I ain't got nothin' to say about it, mother; an' I ain't goin' to say nothin'.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 73) develops women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. Its words “nothin'” and “mother” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “We ain't had no new paper on it for ten year, an' then I put it on myself, an' it didn't cost but ninepence a roll.” (paragraph 76), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women's rights in marriage as central.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 113 shapes its tone: “Mrs. Penn's face, as she worked, changed, her perplexed forehead smoothed, her eyes were steady, her lips firmly set.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “perplexed” and “smoothed” (paragraph 113) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 52 shapes its tone: “Lots of girls have to that ain't no stronger an' better able to than you be.’”

Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “stronger” and “better” (paragraph 52) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 68 shapes its tone: “Mrs. Penn led the way into the kitchen, and pointed to a chair.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “pointed” and “kitchen” (paragraph 68) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 80 to the story's treatment of quiet rebellion: “It is forty year now, an' you've been makin' more money, an' I've been savin' of it for you ever since, an' you ain't built no house yet.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 80) develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. Its words “you've” and “makin'” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “She'll have to go somewheres else to live away from us, an' it don't seem as if I could have it so, noways, father.” (paragraph 82), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating quiet rebellion as central.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of quiet rebellion: “You ain't goin' to build a barn over there where we was goin' to have a house, father?'” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 19) develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. Its words “father” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It was scarcely as commodious for people as the little boxes under the barn eaves were for doves.” (paragraph 21), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating quiet rebellion as central.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 99 shapes its tone: “Adoniram had planned to move his stock in on Wednesday; on Tuesday he received a letter which changed his plans.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “received” and “planned” (paragraph 99) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 44 shapes its tone: “The girl went to the sink, and began to wash the dishes that were piled up there.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “dishes” (paragraph 44) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 103 to the story's treatment of women's rights in marriage: “I told Hiram to watch out, an' if he got wind of a good horse to let me know.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 103) develops women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He looked at his wife, and his manner was defiantly apologetic, ‘If them cows come to-day, Sammy can drive 'em into the…” (paragraph 106), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women's rights in marriage as central.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 128 to the story's treatment of quiet rebellion: “Mrs. Penn did not eat anything herself She went into the pantry, and they heard her moving dishes while they ate.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 128) develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. Its words “anything” and “herself” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He ran his words together, and his speech was almost as inarticulate as a growl.” (paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating quiet rebellion as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 57 to the story's treatment of women's rights in marriage: “Adoniram asked a blessing, and they ate promptly, then rose up and went about their work.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 57) develops women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. Its words “blessing” and “promptly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Adoniram went to work out in the yard unloading wood from the wagon.” (paragraph 60), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women's rights in marriage as central.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Penn did not speak of it, and Adoniram did not mention it to her, although sometimes, upon a return from inspecting it, he bore himself with injured dignity.”, what does “inspecting” most nearly mean?
    A. ran with short quick steps
    B. careful and persistent
    C. looking at closely; examining
    D. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice

    Key: C (looking at closely; examining)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “However deep a resentment she might be forced to hold against her husband, she would never fail in sedulous attention to his wants.”, what does “sedulous” most nearly mean?
    A. ran with short quick steps
    B. careful and persistent
    C. looking at closely; examining
    D. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice

    Key: B (careful and persistent)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 117 to the story's treatment of women's rights in marriage: “The load of hay from the west field came slowly down the cart track, and drew up at the new barn.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 117) develops women's rights in marriage: she acts rather than argues. Its words “slowly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Well, I s'pose he changed his mind.' He took hold of the horses' bridles.” (paragraph 122), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women's rights in marriage as central.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from paragraph 76 to the story's treatment of quiet rebellion: “What would you have thought, father, if we had had our weddin' in a room no better than this?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 76) develops quiet rebellion: she acts rather than argues. Its words “thought” and “weddin'” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “She flung open a door and disclosed a tiny

bedroom, only large enough for a bed and bureau, with a path between." (paragraph 77), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating quiet rebellion as central.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] In the line "Men assembled in the store and talked it over, women with shawls over their heads scuttled into each other's houses before their work was done.", what does "scuttled" most nearly mean?

    A. careful and persistent

    B. looking at closely; examining

    C. ran with short quick steps

    D. talk indistinctly; usually in a low voice

    Key: C (ran with short quick steps)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	8, 1, 3, 9, 6, 5, 10, 4, 2, 7, 11, 12, 14, 13, 19, 20, 21, 22	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 1, 4, 6, 10, 7, 5, 2, 8, 13, 12, 11, 14, 15, 20, 21, 22, 23	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 5, 10, 7, 1, 2, 6, 8, 12, 11, 13, 14, 21, 20, 16, 24, 23, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 2, 7, 6, 3, 8, 4, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 20, 17, 25, 26, 27, 28	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	29, 30, 10, 12, 13, 11, 14, 19, 25, 16, 21, 15, 24, 22, 31, 23, 18, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	5, 2, 30, 14, 13, 11, 21, 15, 19, 25, 17, 20, 28, 32, 22, 23, 26, 18	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Sophomore	1, 5, 10, 11, 12, 14, 25, 17, 19, 15, 16, 24, 18, 27, 23, 22, 28, 26	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	29, 4, 30, 12, 11, 25, 20, 19, 24, 15, 17, 31, 26, 28, 32, 22, 18, 23	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	4, 30, 33, 11, 19, 21, 16, 20, 24, 25, 22, 31, 27, 28, 18, 32, 23, 26	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	4, 30, 33, 19, 25, 21, 17, 15, 24, 20, 26, 28, 27, 18, 31, 22, 23, 32	recall 3, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 8

Final paper

The Revolt of "Mother": final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops women's rights in marriage across The Revolt of "Mother". Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Revolt of "Mother" and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to home and dignity.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Revolt of "Mother". Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Revolt of "Mother" finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of quiet rebellion. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Sarah's action succeeds where forty years of words failed. The text makes this visible when it says “Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph” (The Revolt of "Mother", paragraph 165). Adoniram admits "I hadn't no idee you was so set on't," and "Sarah put her apron up to her face; she was overcome by her own triumph.". A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Women's rights in marriage

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Revolt of "Mother" teaches about women's rights in marriage. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother". Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops women's rights in marriage across The Revolt of "Mother". Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Revolt of "Mother" (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of women's rights in marriage. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother". Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman's choices in The Revolt of "Mother" (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of women's rights in marriage, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Revolt of "Mother"'s treatment of women's rights in marriage in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother" that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother". Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother", engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on women's rights in marriage in The Revolt of "Mother", engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Home and dignity

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Revolt of "Mother" teaches about home and dignity. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother". Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops home and dignity across The Revolt of "Mother". Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Revolt of "Mother" (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of home and dignity. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother". Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman's choices in The Revolt of "Mother" (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of home and dignity, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Revolt of "Mother"'s treatment of home and dignity in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother" that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother". Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother", engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on home and dignity in The Revolt of "Mother", engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Quiet rebellion

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Revolt of "Mother" teaches about quiet rebellion. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops quiet rebellion in The Revolt of "Mother". Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman develops quiet rebellion across The Revolt of "Mother". Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Revolt of "Mother" (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of quiet rebellion. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of quiet rebellion in The Revolt of "Mother". Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary E. Wilkins Freeman's choices in The Revolt of "Mother" (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of quiet rebellion, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Revolt of "Mother"'s treatment of quiet rebellion in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on quiet rebellion in The Revolt of "Mother" that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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